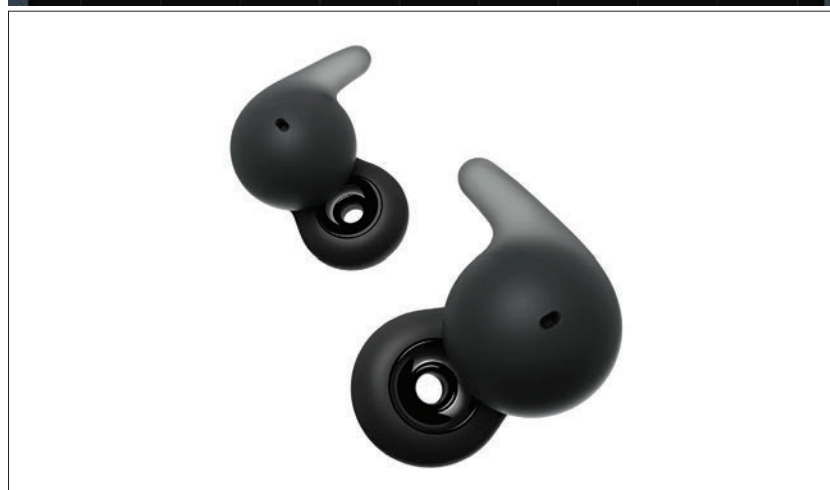
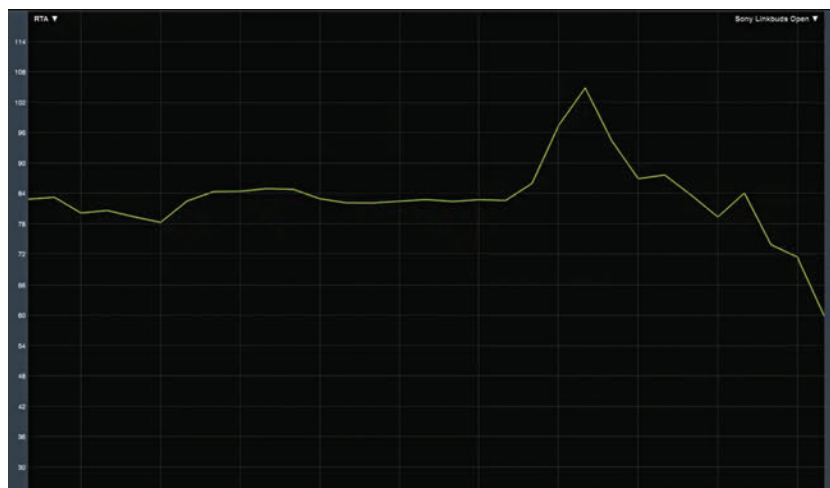




build ensures long-lasting comfort during extended use, though stability issues may arise during high-intensity activities. In quieter environments, the lack of noise isolation can be distracting, especially when competing with ambient noises like office chatter or household appliances. These earbuds clearly cater to a niche audience and may not appeal to those seeking immersive listening experiences.

BATTERY LIFE

Battery life on the LinkBuds Open is adequate but not groundbreaking. Sony claims up to eight hours of playback on a single charge, with additional charge cycles from the case totalling up to 13 hours. In real-world usage, these numbers hold up, provided you're not using power-hungry features like Speak-to-Chat excessively. In our testing, we

found that on a single charge, these earbuds held up for 6.5 hours of continuous charge.

Fast charging is a welcome addition, offering up to 90 minutes of playback with just 10 minutes of charging. However, the omission of wireless charging feels like a glaring drawback, especially when competitors in this price range include it as standard.

VERDICT

At a retail price of ₹19,990 (at the time of writing), the LinkBuds Open positions itself in a competitive market. Alternatives like the Bose Sport Open Earbuds offer similar transparency-focused designs but come with a more secure fit. Meanwhile, traditional in-ear models like the Jabra Elite 7 Pro provide better sound isolation and bass response at a comparable price point.

Sony's decision to forgo high-resolution codec support and wireless charging raises questions about the overall value proposition. While the LinkBuds Open shines in specific use cases, its appeal remains limited to those who prioritise open-air listening above all else.

The Sony LinkBuds Open is an ambitious product that delivers on its promise of environmental awareness and transparency. Its unique design and feature set make it a standout choice for users who value situational awareness over immersive sound. However, the limited codec support, lack of wireless charging, and inconsistent fit may deter potential buyers.

For outdoor use and casual listeners who appreciate a wide soundstage and natural ambient integration, the LinkBuds Open is a worthy consideration. However, audiophiles and bass lovers may find better options elsewhere. In the end, this is a niche product that excels within its defined parameters but struggles to justify its premium price tag for a broader audience.

—Satvik Pandey

SPECIFICATIONS

Size and Weight - Weight: Approx. 5.1g x 2 (including fitting supporters) | General Features - Headphone Type: Open Air | DRIVER UNIT: 11 mm | Magnet: High-power neodymium magnets | Frequency Response (Bluetooth® Communication): 20 Hz–20,000 Hz (44.1 kHz sampling) | Volume Control: Yes | Waterproof: Yes (IPX4 equivalent) | NFC: Yes | DSEE: Yes | Battery - Battery Charge Time: Approx. 1.5 hrs | Battery Charge Method: USB charge (with case) | Battery Life (Continuous Music Playback Time): Max. 8 hrs | Battery Life(Continuous Communication Time): Max. 4.5 hrs | Battery Life (Waiting Time): Max. 13 hrs | Bluetooth® Specification - Bluetooth® Version: Bluetooth Specification Version 5.3 | Effective Range: 10 m | Frequency Range: 2.4 GHz band (2.400 0 GHz–2.483 5 GHz) | Profile: A2DP, AVRCP, HFP, HSP, TMAP, CSIP, MCP, VCP, CCP | Supported Audio Format(S): SBC, AAC, LC3 | Supported Content Protection: SCMS-T | Charging Case - Weight: Approx. 30.6 g | Dimension: Approx. 46.0 x 46.0 x 29.4 mm | Battery Charge Time: Approx. 2.5 hrs (USB charging)

CONTACT

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